

Whitman County Veterans Services (WCVS)

Accessibility Conformance Statement & Report

Website: <https://whitmanvs.com>

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Date: March 20, 2026

1. Accessibility Statement

The Whitman County Veterans Services (WCVS) e-Post Hub has been developed to align with the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1 Level AA.

Based on internal testing and evaluation, the public-facing portions of the website substantially conform to WCAG 2.1 Level AA standards, including support for keyboard navigation, visible focus indicators, semantic structure, labeled forms, and screen reader compatibility.

Accessibility has been incorporated throughout the design and development process. Remaining items are minor, non-blocking enhancements and are part of ongoing accessibility improvements.

Whitman County Veterans Services (WCVS) is committed to ensuring digital accessibility for all users. Our goal is to provide an accessible and inclusive experience by implementing recognized accessibility practices and continuously improving usability for all visitors.

Accessibility Features

The website includes, but is not limited to, the following features:

- Full keyboard navigation support.
- Visible focus indicators for interactive elements.
- Semantic HTML structure for assistive technologies.
- Descriptive alternative text for images.
- Accessible forms with proper labels and instructions.
- Sufficient color contrast for readability.
- Responsive design supporting zoom and reflow.
- Screen reader compatibility (tested with VoiceOver)

- External link warnings for user awareness

Ongoing Efforts

Accessibility is an ongoing effort. While we strive to ensure full accessibility, some areas may still be under refinement. We are actively working to improve and maintain compliance with WCAG 2.1 Level AA standards.

Feedback

If you experience any accessibility barriers or need assistance, please contact current developers:

logancribbs6@gmail.com - Logan Cribbs

lysherchhi02@gmail.com - Chhi Ly

Future developers may be appended to or replace the contact list.

2. Accessibility Conformance Summary

Standard: WCAG 2.1 Level AA

Scope: WCVS e-Post Hub

Evaluation Methods:

- Manual keyboard navigation testing.
 - Screen reader testing (VoiceOver)
 - Visual inspection of UI/UX components.
 - Accessibility tools (e.g., WAVE, Lighthouse, Axe)
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3. Testing Evidence

WAVE Extension Evaluation

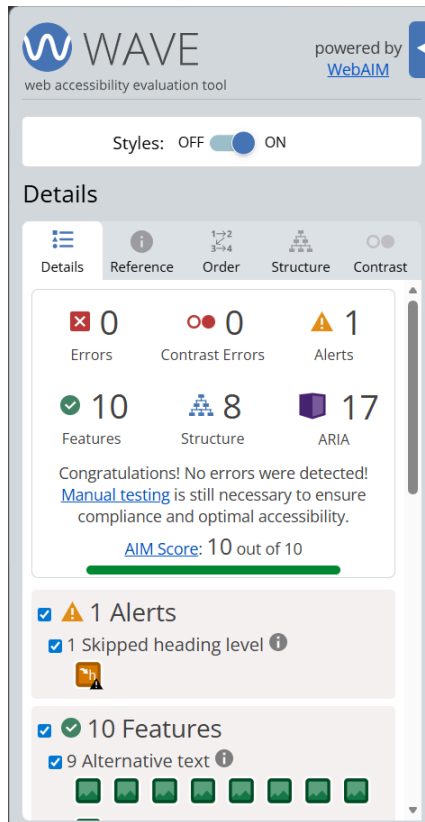


Figure 1 WAVE Tool Snippet

Notes:

- No Significant Error/Contrast Errors.
- Alert - Heading leveling due to Slideshow placement.
- Multiple Alternative texts.
- Emphasized the web structure.

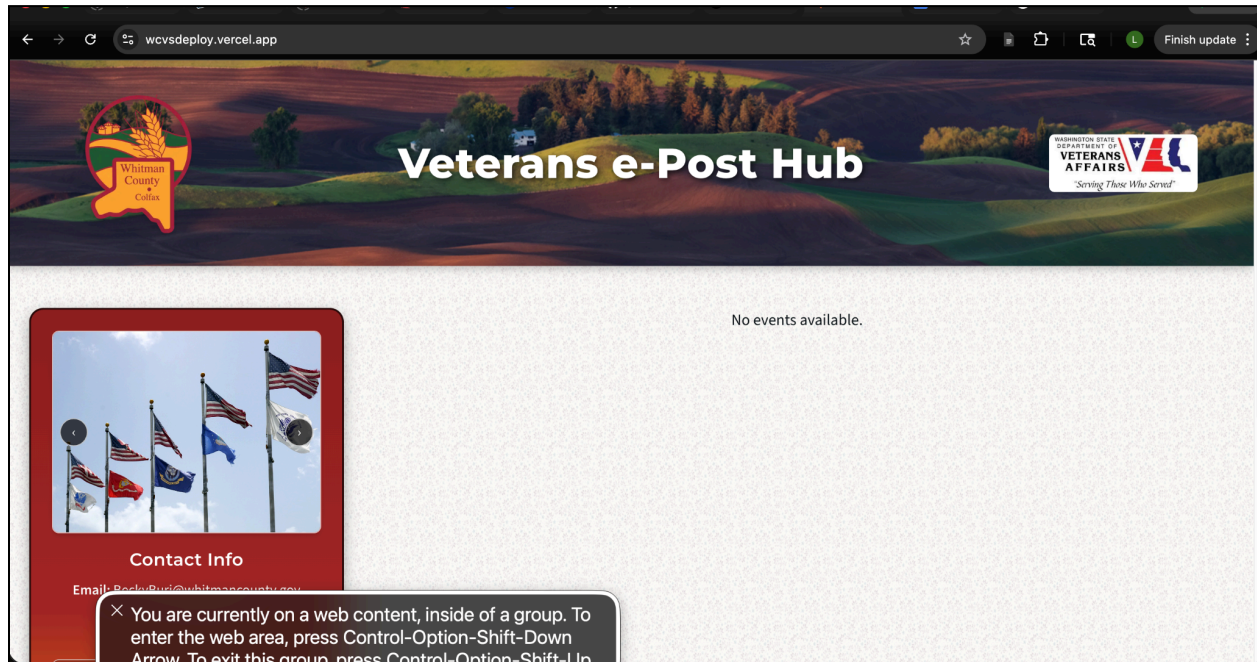
Keyboard Navigation Testing

Notes:

- All interactive elements are reachable via keyboard (*Tab* and *Shift + Tab* keys for next and back, respectively)
- Logical tab order maintained.

- No keyboard traps detected.
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Screen Reader Testing



Tested with: VoiceOver

Notes:

- Elements properly announced.
 - Forms labeled correctly.
 - Navigation structure is understandable.
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Color Contrast & Visual Accessibility

Please refer to Figure 1.

Notes:

- Text meets WCAG contrast requirements.
 - UI elements are distinguishable.
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4. WCAG 2.1 AA Conformance Table (VPAT)

Perceivable (1.x)

Criteria	Conformance	Remarks
1.1.1 Non-text Content	Supports	Images include descriptive alt text
1.2.x Media Alternatives	Not Applicable	No audio/video content present
1.3.1 Info and Relationships	Supports	Semantic HTML structure used
1.3.2 Meaningful Sequence	Supports	Logical reading order maintained
1.3.3 Sensory Characteristics	Supports	Instructions not reliant on visual cues alone
1.3.4 Orientation	Supports	Responsive layout supported
1.3.5 Identify Input Purpose	Supports	Inputs include labels and types
1.4.1 Use of Color	Supports	Color not sole method of conveying info
1.4.3 Contrast (Minimum)	Supports	Meets contrast requirements
1.4.4 Resize Text	Supports	Content usable when zoomed
1.4.10 Reflow	Supports	Layout adapts to screen size
1.4.11 Non-text Contrast	Supports	UI elements meet contrast requirements
1.4.12 Text Spacing	Supports	No content loss with spacing changes
1.4.13 Content on Hover/Focus	Partially Supports	Some dynamic UI elements under refinement

Operable (2.x)

Criteria	Conformance	Remarks
2.1.1 Keyboard	Supports	Full keyboard navigation implemented
2.1.2 No Keyboard Trap	Supports	No traps detected

2.4.1 Bypass Blocks	Partially Supports	Skip navigation may be limited
2.4.2 Page Titled	Supports	Pages have descriptive titles
2.4.3 Focus Order	Supports	Logical navigation order
2.4.4 Link Purpose	Supports	Links are descriptive
2.4.5 Multiple Ways	Supports	Navigation available via multiple paths
2.4.6 Headings and Labels	Supports	Clear headings and labels
2.4.7 Focus Visible	Supports	Visible focus indicators implemented
2.5.x Input Modalities	Supports	No complex gestures required

Understandable (3.x)

Criteria	Conformance	Remarks
3.1.1 Language of Page	Supports	Language defined correctly
3.2.1 On Focus	Supports	No unexpected changes
3.2.2 On Input	Supports	Predictable behavior
3.2.3 Consistent Navigation	Supports	Navigation consistent
3.2.4 Consistent Identification	Supports	Components consistently labeled
3.3.1 Error Identification	Partially Supports	Error messaging may be limited
3.3.2 Labels or Instructions	Supports	Forms clearly labeled
3.3.3 Error Suggestion	Partially Supports	Suggestions may be limited
3.3.4 Error Prevention	Supports	Safeguards in place for key actions

Robust (4.x)

Criteria	Conformance	Remarks
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4.1.1 Parsing	Supports	No major HTML errors
4.1.2 Name, Role, Value	Supports	Elements expose accessible properties
4.1.3 Status Messages	Partially Supports	Dynamic updates may not always be announced

5. Limitations & Ongoing Improvements

The WCVS team acknowledges that accessibility is a continuous process. Current areas of ongoing refinement include:

- Enhancing dynamic content announcements for assistive technologies.
- Improving error messaging and validation feedback.
- Considering the implementation of skip navigation links.

These items do not prevent use of the site, but are being addressed to further strengthen accessibility.

6. Results

Based on current testing and implementation, the WCVS e-Post Hub:

Substantially conforms to WCAG 2.1 Level AA standards for public-facing content, with ongoing improvements in progress.

7. Conclusion

The WCVS development team has made a good-faith effort to design and implement an accessible web experience aligned with recognized standards. Accessibility considerations have been integrated throughout the development process, including keyboard navigation, screen reader compatibility, and visual accessibility.

Ongoing evaluation and improvements will continue to ensure the platform remains inclusive and compliant with evolving accessibility standards.
